



GREEN TECHNOLOGY

Why Should You Invest?



"If I had asked people what they wanted, they would have said faster horses."—Henry Ford

The world is changing and one of the effects of these changes is on how we consume energy. The global annual average consumption of conventional energy has increased by 1.8 per cent, overall, from 2011 till 2017. If we look at the data closely, this increase is primarily driven by developing nations, whereas the developed world is moving towards alternate energy forms.

The United Nations Environment Program (UNEP), in collaboration with the Frankfurt School of Finance and Management, has released a report titled 'Global Trends in Renewable Energy Investment', which states that though there was a 23 per cent fall in

investments in renewable energy in 2016, yet, the overall number of renewable power installations/capacities has gone up over the last decade, and was at an all-time high in 2015 (Figure 1). This shows that the demand for renewable energy remains strong despite a fall in investor interest. There can be many reasons for this fall in interest, one of which is the financing of projects.

In the developing nations, on the other hand, it's a different story overall. Even if conventional energy still dominates energy consumption, infrastructural development in the non-core energy sector has gone up, aligned with government policies. This has

created a conducive environment for investments. So, to the question, when is the right time to invest in green tech, I would say, "Now!"

Green technology and the related investment patterns

Technology is the application of knowledge to fulfil practical requirements. When technology is applied in a way that has minimal impact on the environment, by the sustainable use of natural resources in a manner that is socially equitable and economically viable, it is termed as green technology. In the contem-

